NOVEMBER 4 – 12, 2026 · FIRST TRIP

Nine days in *Japan.*

Tokyo, one night in the Niigata mountains, one night at Lake Kawaguchiko. Times are Japan Standard Time. Add 10 minutes inside Shinjuku, Tokyo, and Shibuya stations.

Narita — Wed 4
Ueno — 3 nights
Niigata — Sat 7
Akihabara — Sun 8
Fuji — Mon 9
Shinjuku — 2 nights
Narita — Thu 12

WED 4 · DAY 1
Land in Ueno
Skyliner, 41 min. Miura Misaki sushi.

THU 5 · DAY 2
Asakusa, then Sky
Street sunset 16:42. Roof at 18:20.

FRI 6 · DAY 3
Old Tokyo houses
Museum, Nakano, Harajuku, monja.

SAT 7 · DAY 4
Koi, then onsen
Backpack only. Izumiya kaiseki.

SUN 8 · DAY 5
Owls at 14:00
Toki around 10:19. Then Akihabara.

MON 9 · DAY 6
Lake, backpacks
Suitcases go to Shinjuku. Train 09:30.

TUE 10 · DAY 7
Red pagoda
Backpacks only. Home on the 14:58, car 3.

WED 11 · DAY 8
Skytree & aquarium
Penguins at 13:30. Tempura at 19:00.

THU 12 · DAY 9
Fly at 17:30
Backpacks to Tokyo. Suitcases wait at Narita.

Lock these in.

TICKETS & TABLES

BOOKED · THURSDAY NOV 5

Shibuya Sky
enter 18:20

Night view, not sunset. Sunset is 16:42, from the street. Stay until you leave for dinner at 19:40. No re-entry. No suitcase.

BOOKED · SUNDAY NOV 8

Akiba Fukurou
session 14:00

Be outside at 13:40. 67 Kanda Neribeicho, 3 minutes from JR Akihabara Central Gate. About one hour. They do not serve a meal.

☐ THU 5 · 20:00

Han no Daidokoro

Yamagata beef, 7F on Dōgenzaka, a walk from Shibuya Sky. Order the meat yourself. About ¥32,000 for 3, with drinks for 2. Call 03-5489-7655.

☐ FRI 6 · 19:30

Moheji Honten

The monja shop locals line up for. Mentaiko-mochi with cheese, plus a seafood pan. About ¥12,000 for 3, sake for 2. Call 03-6204-2314.

☐ WED 11 · 19:00

Tempura Tenhide

West Shinjuku, open Wednesday. B course ¥8,250 each. About ¥29,000 for 3, sake for 2. Call 03-5386-3630. Same-day cancel is the course.

Sunday train: book the 10:19 Toki, Nagaoka → Ueno.

About 1 hour 25–35 minutes, reserved seat near ¥9,320. Taxi from the ryokan at 9:15. The 10:45 still works. An 11:55 gets you to Ueno around 13:20 and misses a calm 14:00 owl check-in. There is no 11:00 train that arrives at 12:35.

NOV 4–7

MIMARU Ueno North
All 6 bags in the room. Out with backpacks.

NOV 7

Izumiya, Yomogihira
3 backpacks. Suitcases go to Inaricho.

NOV 8

MIMARU Inaricho
Suitcases are already there from Saturday night.

NOV 9

Maruei, Kawaguchiko
Backpacks only. Suitcases go to Shinjuku West.

NOV 10–12

MIMARU Shinjuku West
Suitcases arrive Monday night. Send them to Narita Wednesday.

ALSO BOOK

3 suitcase deliveries
¥2,600 each. Reserve by 23:00 the night before.

Six trains need a seat.

BOOK THESE. TAP THE REST.

Tuesday home is booked. Fuji Excursion 36, car 3, seats 4B, 4C, 4D. Nov 10, 14:58 Kawaguchiko to 16:59 Shinjuku. Print that paper at a JR machine in Tokyo before Monday, with the card you paid with. Monday's 09:30 can sell out the way the 14:08 did. Book it on the same site tonight. If 09:30 is full, take 10:30, not 08:30. You are still at the hotel desk at 8:15.

WHEN	TRAIN	WHERE YOU WALK
Wed 4	Skyliner to Keisei-Ueno. 41 min. About ¥2,570. No need to buy before you fly.	After customs, follow Skyliner / Keisei signs in the terminal you landed in. Ignore Narita Express. Buy 3 seats on the next train. Stand at the car on the ticket.
Sat 7 · 08:30	Toki. Tokyo → Nagaoka. About 1h40. About ¥9,000–11,000.	Ueno to Tokyo is one local stop. At Tokyo follow Tohoku / Joetsu / Hokuriku, platforms 20–23. Check the board. Platforms 14–19 go to Kyoto and Osaka. Be at your car 10 minutes early.
Sun 8 · 10:19	Toki. Nagaoka → Ueno. About 1h30. About ¥9,320. Backup 10:45.	Taxi to the East Exit. Shinkansen gate. Get off at Ueno. The train keeps going to Tokyo.
Mon 9 · 09:30	Fuji Excursion. Shinjuku → Kawaguchiko. Not booked yet. About 2 hours. About ¥4,200. Backup 10:30.	JR Shinjuku, the green JR logo. Platforms 9 or 10, then the board. Sit in the car on the ticket, usually 1–3. The cars behind split off at Otsuki.
Tue 10 · booked	Morning local, no seat. 09:00 to Shimoyoshida, back on the 12:40. Fuji Excursion 36, 14:58–16:59. Car 3, seats 4B, 4C, 4D.	Morning: follow 大月, get off 下吉田. Afternoon: follow 富士回遊 / 新宿 and sit in car 3. Stay there when cars are added at Otsuki.
Thu 12 · by 13:15	Narita Express. Tokyo → Narita. 53–60 min. Book a train between 12:45 and 13:15.	Tokyo Station signs: Narita Express / 成田エクスプレス. JR, not Skyliner. The ticket must end at T1 or T2, the same terminal as the suitcases.

Everything else is a tap.

Ginza Line, Yamanote, Hibiya, Chuo, the subway to Tsukishima. One Suica per person, bought at Narita, charged with ¥5,000–10,000. Touch in and touch out. A reserved seat is not paid by tapping a blank Suica.

If you are early, you are fine.

These trains leave on the minute. Ten minutes at the car is enough. Missed it? Tell the station staff the train name. They put you on the next one. You do not have to solve the gate alone.

Call before you fly.

WHAT TO ORDER

15:00–16:30 in Japan.

That is 1:00–2:30 AM US Eastern in November. Awake window: 8:30–9:30 PM Eastern, which is 10:30–11:30 AM the next morning in Tokyo. Do not call during dinner, 18:00–21:00 Japan time.

Totals are the table for 3.

Two of you drink sake, about two pours each. The third person is food and a soft drink. Train and ticket prices on the other pages are still per adult.

THU NOV 5 · 20:00 · RESERVE

About ¥32,000 for 3

Han no Daidokoro Bettei

A5 Yamagata beef on the 7th floor, Dōgenzaka Center Building, 2-29-8 Dōgenzaka. Two minutes from Shibuya Station, so you walk here from Shibuya Sky. Dinner until 22:30, last order 22:00. TripAdvisor 4.6 from 459 reviews.

Order the meat yourself. Two shared 6-kind Yamagata platters (¥7,500 each), the limited otoro tongue (¥2,480), top harami (¥2,780), and one chateaubriand sukiyaki (¥3,480). Kimchi, then a cold noodle each. Drinks for two are about ¥4,000–5,000. Japanese Tabelog is 3.32, and a July 2026 review says the preset courses pad the bill with sides.

Book 03-5489-7655 at 15:00–16:30 Japan time, or the shop's online form. Skip the 050 numbers from the US.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1066456-d3752339-Reviews-Hanno_Daidokoro_Bettei-Shibuya_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

FRI NOV 6 · 19:30 · RESERVE

About ¥12,000 for 3

Moheji Honten, Tsukishima

The monja counter locals rank first on the street. Seafood dashi, staff cook it for you. 3-16-9 Tsukishima, about 3 minutes from the station. Weekday dinner 17:00–23:00. TripAdvisor barely lists this shop. The Japanese score is the one that matters: it is the line people join.

Order mentaiko-mochi monja with cheese (¥1,738 + ¥330), a seafood monja (¥1,880), and one more pan. Add a grilled squid to share. Sake or beer for two is about ¥2,500.

Book 03-6204-2314. 24 seats, so a Friday 19:30 needs the call. Iroha, the old pick, is 3.9 from 42 reviews.

WED NOV 11 · 19:00 · RESERVE

About ¥29,000 for 3

Tempura Tenhide, Nishi-Shinjuku

7-12-21 Nishi-Shinjuku. Seven minutes from the JR west exit, on the same side as the hotel. Open Wednesday, 17:00–22:00, last order 21:00. Closed Sunday. No service charge. Tabelog 3.51 from about 700 reviews, and a 2022 Tempura 100 pick. Tsunahachi's page is the one full of "one prawn" complaints, and that building is closed.

Order the B course, ¥8,250 each: 10 pieces of tempura, a small bowl, then tendon or tempura chazuke, and dessert. Three courses are ¥24,750. About ¥4,000 more for two pours of sake each for two people.

Book 03-5386-3630. Say you saw the website. A same-day cancel of a course is the full course price. Tenkane, the other West Shinjuku counter, is closed on Wednesday, and Nov 11 is a Wednesday.

Walk in. Don’t call.

SHOW UP HUNGRY

WED 4 ~19:45 · SUN 8 ~18:15

Miura Misaki, Ueno

Tuna wholesaler, about 19 counter seats, 6-12-14 Ueno. No reservations. Suitcases stay in the hotel room. A wait at 18:00–20:00 is normal.

Order the heaped chūtoro or negitoro gunkan, the Misaki tuna assortment, and aburi toro. On Sunday, order what you skipped.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14134274-d3760771-Reviews-Magurodonya_Miura_Misakiko_Ueno-Ueno_Taito_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

THU 5 · 15:10 · NO BOOKING

Uobei, Dōgenzaka

Booths, English touchscreen, plates on a little track. This is the sushi meal. Dinner is the yakiniku.

Order aburi salmon and a shrimp tempura roll.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1066456-d3871559-Reviews-Uobei_Shibuya_Dogenzaka-Shibuya_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

MON 9 · 12:00 · EXPECT A LINE

Hōtō Fudō, Ekimae

The white cloud building at 3631-2 Funatsu, by Kawaguchiko Station. Not the Minami branch. One bowl is lunch.

Order hōtō: flat noodles, miso, pumpkin, mountain vegetables.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g1165976-d1664155-Reviews-Hoto_Fudo_Kawaguchiko_Ekimae-Fujikawaguchiko_machi_Minamitsuru_gun_Yamanashi_Prefecture_Koshinetsu_Chubu.html

TUE 10 · ONLY IF SEATED BY 18:20

A Happy Pancake, Ginza

Soufflé pancakes. The train gets you to Ginza after 17:30, and weekdays close about 19:30. If the board is later than 18:20, skip it. Sushi is the meal.

Order the plain one with butter and maple.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129573-d14192375-Reviews-A_Happy_Pancake_Ginza-Ginza_Chuo_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

TUE 10 · AFTER PANCAKES · 24 HOURS

Sushi Zanmai Honten

4-11-9 Tsukiji, the main shop with the tuna figure. Reservations are not accepted. If the line is over 40 minutes, pick another counter on the block.

Order the otoro / chūtoro set. Counter seat if one is open.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129610-d3597142-Reviews-Sushizanmai_Honten-Tsukiji_Chuo_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kanto.html

THU 12 · 11:45 · LEAVE BY 13:00

Nemuro Hanamaru, KITTE 5F

Hokkaido fish, across from Tokyo Station’s Marunouchi south side. Not the basement. No reservations. The review page spells it “Nemuiro.”

Order off the menu: fatty tuna, salmon in white soy, hontaku.

https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurant_Review-g14129528-d5015864-Reviews-Nemuiro_Hanamaru_Kitte_Marunouchi-Marunouchi_Chiyoda_Tokyo_Tokyo_Prefecture_Kan.html

ALREADY IN THE ROOM RATE

Izumiya and Maruei

Kaiseki comes with the stay. At Izumiya, say yes if Murakami wagyu on a hot stone is on the menu. Tell them about the Sunday 9:15 taxi when you confirm the inn, not at dinner.

Ojiya lunch: Sushimasa if the shutter is up (Niigata rice). If not, station soba. Do not reserve it.

WED 11 LUNCH · SUN BACKUP

Solamachi, or Ganso Zushi

Under Skytree, eat a rice bowl or ramen. Tempura is Tenhide that night.

If you skip the second Miura visit, walk into Ganso Zushi at Manseibashi while you are still in Akihabara. No confirmed review page for that counter, so none is printed here.

01
WED

Land, walk, sushi.

All 6 bags come to Ueno North. After that, the suitcases stay in the room.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

15:40

Land at Narita

Economy Plus, so you are off the plane early. Check the terminal on the boarding pass: 1, 2, or 3.

15:40–16:50

Immigration, bags, customs

Plan on 60–90 minutes the first time. Longer if the hall is full.

16:50–17:15

Phone, Suica, then the Skyliner counter

Turn on the eSIM or pick up pocket Wi-Fi. Buy one Suica each and charge ¥5,000–10,000. Follow Skyliner / Keisei signs in your own terminal. Ignore Narita Express. Buy 3 seats on the next train to Keisei-Ueno.

17:20–18:05

Skyliner to Keisei-Ueno · 41 min

Not an hour. Trains every 20–40 minutes. About ¥2,570. Screenshot the car and seat, and stand at that car. Suitcases go in the end racks. This is not the JR train.

18:05–18:25

Walk to the hotel

8–12 minutes from Keisei-Ueno toward the Iriya side. Follow the map pin, not a random “Ueno” sign.

18:25–19:00

Check in. Reserve Saturday’s delivery.

All 6 bags stay in this room through Friday. Reserve Luggage Delivery by MIMARU: 3 suitcases, Ueno North → Inaricho, delivery Saturday. Deadline is Friday 23:00. ¥2,600 each. Passports and both power banks stay out of the cases.

19:00

Convenience-store dinner backup

Egg-salad sandwich, onigiri, milk bread. Fried chicken is Lawson Karaage-kun or FamilyMart Famichiki. 7-Eleven does not sell Famichiki.

19:45–21:15

Sushirun 1 · Miura Misaki-kō

8–12 minute walk into Ameyoko. About 19 seats. Walk in; a wait at this hour is normal. **Order** the heaped chūtoro or negitoro gunkan, the Misaki tuna assortment, and aburi toro. **Tripadvisor reviews**. If the list is past 30 minutes, Toriton nearby. Then sleep.

ATM Seven Bank inside 7-Eleven

Keep out passport for the front desk

Carry-on both battery packs, never in the checked bag

02
THU

Street sunset, roof at night.

Suitcases stay in the Ueno room. You go out with the 3 backpacks.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

09:20	**Ginza Line to Asakusa · 5–7 min** ¥180. Exit toward Kaminarimon. Red lantern, then Nakamise-dōri. Eat in this order: warm ningyō-yaki, strawberry daifuku, Asakusa Menchi, Kagetsudō melon pan. Then Sensō-ji and the pagoda.
12:35	**Same line straight to Shibuya** About 35 minutes on the train, 45–50 door to door. ¥250.
13:20–15:00	**Shibuya Parco, 6th floor** Nintendo Tokyo and Pokémon Center Shibuya. This is not the Skytree store. If they are handing out numbered tickets, take one or come back later.
15:10–16:10	**Sushirun 2 · Uobei, Dōgenzaka** 8–12 minutes from Parco. English screen, plates on the little tracks. No reservation. **Order** aburi salmon and a shrimp tempura roll. Tripadvisor reviews. Dinner is the beef.
16:15–17:45	**Sunset from the street. Sun sets 16:42.** Miyashita Park roof by 16:30. Then the scramble itself. Then MEGA Don Quijote on Center-gai for KitKats and small things.
18:20–19:40	**Shibuya Sky · ticketed entry** Be at the 14F gate by 17:50. Lit crossing, Skytree to the east. You can stay until about 22:30, but leave at 19:40. One exit. If wind closes the roof, the indoor gallery on 46 still opens.
20:00–22:00	**Han no Daidokoro Bettei · table held** Walk from Shibuya Sky. 7F, Dōgenzaka Center Building, 2-29-8 Dōgenzaka. **Order** two 6-kind Yamagata platters, otoro tongue, top harami, and one chateaubriand sukiyaki. About ¥32,000 for 3, drinks for 2. Call 03-5489-7655. Tripadvisor reviews, 4.6 from 459. Back to Ueno about 35 minutes.

BAGS
The 3 suitcases do not leave the hotel. Shibuya Sky allows a day backpack. If a pack is stuffed with plush, locker that one pack at Shibuya Station. Do not locker a suitcase.

IF THE SHOPS ARE SLAMMED
Pokémon Center Skytree Town on Wednesday has different stock. Do not burn the sunset hour in a line.

03
FRI

Houses, then Harajuku.

Suitcases stay in the room. Tonight, pack the 3 backpacks for the onsen.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno North

08:30 — **Leave after breakfast**
Yamanote to Shinjuku (~25 min), Chūō Rapid to Musashi-Koganei (~25 min). North exit, Seibu bus platform 2 or 3. Off at Koganei-kōen Nishi-guchi, 5-minute walk. Door to door 75–85 minutes.

09:45–14:15 — **Edo-Tokyo Open Air Architectural Museum**
Inside the park. November hours 9:30–16:30, last entry 16:00, ¥400. Go into the houses. Find Kodakara-yu, the old bath that fed the look of the one in Spirited Away. Lunch at the museum café around 13:00.

14:50–16:20 — **Nakano Broadway**
Bus back, then the Chūō line, about 20 minutes. Mandarake and vintage figures. A different pile from Akihabara, which is Sunday.

16:50–18:20 — **Harajuku, small bites only**
Chūō to Shinjuku, Yamanote to Harajuku, about 25 minutes total. One crêpe or takoyaki on Takeshita-dōri, then Cat Street. Dinner is a full meal.

19:30–21:15 — **Moheji Honten, Tsukishima · table held**
Leave Harajuku at 18:20. Yamanote to Yūrakuchō, then the subway, 35–40 minutes. 3-16-9 Tsukishima. **Order** mentaiko-mochi with cheese, a seafood monja, and one more pan. About ¥12,000 for 3, sake for 2. Call 03-6204-2314. Tonight each person packs their own backpack: one spare outfit, sleep shirt, socks, mini toiletries, charger, warm layer. The 3 suitcases stay closed for the desk.

IF YOU ALREADY HOLD GHIBLI TICKETS
Do the museum in Mitaka this morning and skip the open-air park. Both want half a day. Nakano and Harajuku still fit after.

IF THE BUILDINGS GRAB YOU
Stay until 15:30 and drop Nakano, not Harajuku. Rain: the rooms are indoors, the paths are not. Nakano Broadway is the indoor swap.

04
SAT

Koi ponds, then the mountain bath.

3 backpacks from here on. The suitcases go to Inaricho and stay there.

SLEEP
Yomogihira
Onsen Izumiya

07:15 — **3 backpacks, nothing else**
Worn clothes plus one spare outfit, sleep shirt, socks, mini toiletries, both batteries, charger, warm layer, taxi cash, a plastic bag. Yukata and towels are at the inn. No second pair of shoes. Passports ride in the backpacks.

07:30 — **Hand all 3 suitcases to the desk**
Do this before you leave. The cutoff is 9:00, and the train will not wait. They reach Inaricho after 20:00 tonight. ¥2,600 each. Get the email receipt. Then you are done with the cases until Sunday night.

08:30 — **Toki, Tokyo Station → Nagaoka**
Leave the hotel by 08:00. Ueno to Tokyo is one local stop. At Tokyo follow Tohoku / Joetsu / Hokuriku Shinkansen, platforms 20–23. Not platforms 14–19. Those go to Kyoto and Osaka. Be at your car number 10 minutes early. Backpacks only.

10:30–13:00 — **Nishikigoi no Sato, Ojiya**
Taxi 35–45 minutes is the calm way. Train to Ojiya is 20 minutes, then a bus. Wooden bridges, collector koi, feed them, then leave. This is the birthplace of colored koi.

13:00 — **Sushirun 4 · lunch in Ojiya**
Walk in. Sushimasa if the shutter is up: Niigata rice under local fish. If it is closed, station soba. Then a taxi to Izumiya, 40–55 minutes. Or return to Nagaoka East for the inn's shuttle, which runs about 13:30–17:00 and must be reserved.

15:00 — **Check in. Book tomorrow's taxi.**
You need to be at Nagaoka Station by 9:50 on Sunday. Ask them to have a taxi at 9:15. Then the alkaline outdoor bath. Shower first. No swimsuit.

19:00 — **Kaiseki in the room**
Included with the stay. Say yes if Murakami wagyu on the hot stone is on the menu. Futons appear while you eat. Sleep early.

Cash rural taxis still want it

App GO taxi, plus the inn's phone number

Tattoos ask before the public bath

05
SUN

Owls at two o’clock.

The early train is the whole trick. Akihabara happens after, not before.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Ueno Inaricho

> Leave Izumiya at 9:15. Toki around 10:19. Ueno around 11:45.
> Backup train is about 10:45, and then lunch becomes a station bento. Do not take the train near 11:55.

07:45–08:45	**Breakfast at the inn** Still sit down for it. Checkout by 9:15 with the backpack only.
09:15–09:45	**Taxi to Nagaoka, East Exit** 25–30 minutes. The Shinkansen gates are on that side. Be there by 9:50.
10:19	**Toki to Ueno · about 1h30** Reserved ordinary around ¥9,320. Sit in the car on the ticket. Get off at Ueno. The train continues to Tokyo.
11:50–13:15	**Drop the 3 backpacks. Eat lunch.** MIMARU Inaricho is a 5–8 minute walk, or 3 minutes from Inaricho station. The 3 suitcases have been at the desk since Saturday night. If the room is not ready, the desk holds the backpacks. Do not unpack. Lunch in Ueno or Ameyoko. You will not be fed with the owls.
13:15	**One stop to Akihabara** Hibiya Line, about 3 minutes. Or walk 15.
13:40–14:50	**Akiba Fukurou · session 14:00** From the Central Gate, turn left. Yodobashi-Akiba is on your right. White building next to the vet. Slippers on. Staff handle the birds. About 50–60 minutes.
14:50–17:30	**Akihabara, unhurried** Super Potato, one GiGO crane floor, then Radio Kaikan or Mandarake. Yodobashi if you need a cable or a memory card.
18:15	**Sushirun 3 · Miura Misaki-kō again** JR back to Ueno in 3–6 minutes. Walk in. **Order** whichever of the heaped gunkan, tuna assortment, or aburi toro you skipped on Wednesday. Tripadvisor reviews. To skip a repeat, eat Ganso Zushi at Manseibashi at 17:30. Hotel is 5–10 minutes after. Open the suitcases, move one lake-night outfit into each backpack, and reserve Monday’s delivery to Shinjuku West before 23:00.

06
MON

Up to the lake.

Backpacks only. The 3 suitcases go to Shinjuku West, not the lake.

SLEEP
Maruei
Kawaguchiko

08:15	**Hand all 3 suitcases to Inaricho** Reserved last night. Delivery today to MIMARU Shinjuku West, cutoff 9:00. They arrive there after 20:00 and wait until you check in Tuesday. ¥2,600 each. Then you carry backpacks only.
08:35	**Inaricho → JR Shinjuku, backpacks** Walk to Ueno, Yamanote 25–30 minutes. Use the station with the green JR logo. Follow Fuji Excursion / 富士回遊 to platforms 9 or 10, then check the board. Not the Odakyu side and not the bus terminal.
09:30–11:28	**Fuji Excursion to Kawaguchiko** About 1 hour 58 minutes. Reserved seats, about ¥4,200. Sit in the car on the ticket, usually cars 1–3. The cars behind split off at Otsuki and do not go to the lake. No transfer for you.
11:30	**Taxi to Maruei · 8–10 min** The free shuttle usually starts at 14:00. Do not wait for it. The room can hold the backpacks if it is not ready.
12:00–13:45	**Hōtō Fudō · the cloud building** 3631-2 Funatsu, by the station. Walk in; lunch lines move. **Order** hōtō: flat noodles, miso, pumpkin, mountain vegetables. One bowl is the meal. Tripadvisor reviews.
14:00	**Lake edge, if the mountain is out** November is a good month. Afternoons still cloud over. Morning light tomorrow is the better bet.
15:00	**Check in** Lake-view room: beds plus tatami. Fill the private indoor bath. Rooftop deck for dusk. Sunset near the lake is about 16:40.
18:30	**Dinner in the hotel** Kaiseki, included. Stay in. Tomorrow morning you leave with the same 3 backpacks. The suitcases are already on their way to Shinjuku.

Dawn look at Fuji before breakfast tomorrow

Train home booked Tue 14:58, car 3, seats 4B 4C 4D

07
TUE

The red pagoda, then Ginza.

Backpacks only. No lockers. The suitcases are already at Shinjuku West.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Shinjuku West

07:30	**Breakfast and a Fuji check** Clearest light is early. Then checkout.
08:30–09:15	**Taxi to Kawaguchiko Station** 8–10 minutes. 3 backpacks. Nothing to lock.
09:00–11:30	**Chūreitō Pagoda** The 09:00 local toward 大月. Not a limited express. Off at 下吉田, about 13 minutes. Follow 忠霊塔, then 398 steps. Suica, or a paper ticket from the machine to Shimoyoshida.
12:40	**Local back to Kawaguchiko** About 13 minutes. The 13:00 also works. The 13:52 is too late. Snack at the station. Be on the platform by 14:45.
14:58–16:59	**Fuji Excursion 36, booked** Car 3, seats 4B, 4C, and 4D. Follow 富士回遊 / 新宿. Stay in car 3 when more cars are added at Otsuki. Shinjuku at 16:59.
17:10	**Straight to Ginza, backpacks on** 20–30 minutes. Do not stop at the hotel first. A Happy Pancake closes about 19:30. Eat there only if you will be seated by 18:20. **Order** the plain soufflé with butter and maple. Tripadvisor reviews.
19:15–20:30	**Sushirun 5 · Sushi Zanmai Honten** 4-11-9 Tsukiji, about 15 minutes on foot from Ginza. Walk in, 24 hours. **Order** the otoro / chūtoro set and sit at the counter if a seat is open. Tripadvisor reviews. Past a 40-minute line, use another counter on the block.
21:00	**MIMARU Shinjuku West** About 25–35 minutes back. Ask the desk for the 3 suitcases that arrived Monday night. Before 23:00, reserve Wednesday's delivery to Narita. Match the terminal on the boarding pass: T1 South Wing or Terminal 2.

08
WED

Tower, jellyfish, tempura.

Suitcases leave for Narita at 8:30. You take the 3 backpacks. No Kirby.

SLEEP
MIMARU Tokyo
Shinjuku West

08:15	**Hand all 3 suitcases to the desk** Reserved last night. Delivery today to Narita, cutoff 9:00. ¥2,600 each. You collect them Thursday at the airport, not tomorrow morning. Passports and power banks stay in the backpacks.
09:15–10:00	**Shinjuku → Tokyo Skytree** 35–50 minutes door to door, backpacks only. Follow Solamachi / Skytree Town signs, not a random tower exit.
10:00–11:30	**Tembo Deck, and Galleria if you bought it** Fast elevators, glass floor, the bay. A timed ticket skips the worst line. Door tickets still exist.
11:30–12:20	**Lunch in Solamachi** A normal restaurant on the food floors. Noodles or a rice set. Tempura is tonight.
12:30–14:00	**Sumida Aquarium, 5F and 6F** Entrance on 5F. Adult ¥2,700. About 90 minutes. Jellyfish and the big Ogasawara tank upstairs, then penguins and goldfish downstairs. Penguin feeding is 13:30. Tickets online or at the door machines.
14:00–17:00	**Floor 4, without Kirby** Pokémon Center Skytree Town, then Donguri Republic for Ghibli. Different stock from Shibuya. Plush goes in the tote.
17:40	**Leave for Shinjuku** 35–50 minutes. A claw machine is allowed only if it cannot make you late.
19:00–20:45	**Tempura Tenhide · table held** 7-12-21 Nishi-Shinjuku, 7 minutes from the JR west exit. **Order** the B course, ¥8,250 each. About ¥29,000 for 3 with sake for 2. Call 03-5386-3630. Same-day cancel is the course price. Tonight pack the 3 backpacks for the flight: passports, meds, both batteries, one change of clothes, fragile souvenirs. The suitcases are already gone.

Ticket Sumida Aquarium, ¥2,700 | **Reservation** Tenhide, 19:00 | **Be there** penguin feeding at 13:30

09
THU

Last sushi, then the airport.

3 backpacks through Tokyo. The suitcases are already at Narita.

DEPART
Narita
17:30

THE MATH
N'EX is 53–60 minutes. Be on the train by 13:15 so you reach the luggage counter around 14:15. The counter stops handing bags over at 15:59.

WHERE THE CASES ARE
JAL ABC departures. Terminal 1 South Wing is 4F. Terminal 2 is 3F. Show the delivery email, then go to airline check-in.

09:30 — **Check out with the 3 backpacks**
Packed last night. Passports, meds, both batteries, one change of clothes, fragile souvenirs. The suitcases left yesterday morning.

10:00–10:40 — **Shinjuku → Tokyo Station**
20–30 minutes with backpacks. No locker stop.

11:00–12:20 — **Sushirun 6 · Nemuro Hanamaru**
KITTE Marunouchi, 5th floor, across from the Marunouchi south side. Walk in. **Order** off the menu: fatty tuna, salmon in white soy, and hontaku. **Tripadvisor reviews**. Be standing up at 12:20.

12:20–12:45 — **Tokyo Character Street**
First Avenue, one floor down. One lap. Buy only what still fits in a backpack.

13:15–14:15 — **Narita Express · 53–60 min**
At Tokyo Station follow Narita Express / 成田エクスプレス. This is JR, not the Skyliner. Reserved seats. The ticket must end at the same terminal as the suitcases, T1 or T2.

14:15 — **Collect the 3 suitcases, then check in**
JAL ABC on the departures floor. T1 South Wing is 4F. Terminal 2 is 3F. Show the delivery email. The counter hands next-day bags over until 15:59. Then airline check-in. Be at the gate 30 minutes before 17:30.

Hard stop Suitcases leave the counter at 15:59

Wrong terminal This service does not deliver to T1 North or T3

Where the six bags are.

3 SUITCASES · 3 BACKPACKS

Three forwards. Same rules each time. Reserve by 23:00 the night before, hand the cases to the MIMARU desk by 8:30, and the cutoff is 9:00. ¥2,600 a suitcase, ¥7,800 a move. Passports, cash, and both power banks ride in the backpacks. No glass bottles in a forwarded case. A case over 30 kg, or more than 180 cm around, gets refused.

DAY	3 SUITCASES	3 BACKPACKS
Wed 4	On the Skyliner with you, then in the Ueno North room.	On you for the walk and for sushi. Then in the room.
Thu 5	Stay in the room all day.	Day bags. Sky allows a backpack. A stuffed pack can use a station locker.
Fri 6	Stay in the room. They stay closed for Saturday's desk.	Day bags. Tonight each person packs one onsen night into their own pack.
Sat 7	Desk at 7:30, before the train. At Inaricho after 20:00.	The only bags. Leave the hotel by 08:00 for the 08:30 Toki.
Sun 8	Already at Inaricho. Open them after dinner.	On the train. Drop them at the desk, then take them to Akihabara. Before 23:00, book Monday's delivery.
Mon 9	Desk by 8:30. They go to Shinjuku West, not the lake. There after 20:00.	The only bags. Fuji Excursion, taxi, and Maruei.
Tue 10	Waiting at Shinjuku West. No lockers at the lake.	Pagoda, then car 3 at 14:58. Hotel after sushi. Ask for the cases. Book Narita before 23:00.
Wed 11	Desk by 8:30. They go to Narita T1 South or T2.	Skytree, the aquarium, and dinner. Tonight, pack them for the flight.
Thu 12	Collect them at JAL ABC departures before 15:59, then check in.	Tokyo Station, sushi, Character Street, and the N'EX. Be on the train by 13:15.

HOP	TIME	
Narita → Ueno, Skyliner	41 min	Reserved
Ueno → Asakusa, Ginza Line	5–7 min	¥180
Asakusa → Shibuya, Ginza Line	35 min ride	~50 door to door
Ueno → museum	75–85 min	Bus at the end
Tokyo → Nagaoka	1h35–1h50	Sat morning
Nagaoka → Ueno	1h25–1h35	Sun ~10:19
Shinjuku → Kawaguchiko	~1h58	Mon 09:30
Kawaguchiko → Shinjuku	~2h	Tue 14:58, car 3
Tokyo → Narita, N'EX	53–60 min	Thu by 13:15